



Strata Civic Solutions

Know the record before you vote.

Municipal decision intelligence: plain-language answers over a city's own published record — budgets, ordinances, minutes, contracts — cited to the page.

Delaware Public Benefit Corporation, foreign-qualified in Texas · San Antonio, TX · 1 September 2026

Draft for joseleos — three slides carry unresolved placeholders. Do not present externally as-is.

THE PROBLEM

The packet is 300 pages. The vote is Tuesday.

A council member in a Texas city of 10,000–50,000 is a part-time official with a separate full-time job and no staff of their own.

200–400

PAGES IN A TYPICAL AGENDA PACKET

Delivered days before the vote, read on personal time.

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STAFF REPORTING TO AN ELECTED OFFICIAL

City staff serve the institution. The official has no researcher, no analyst, no counsel of their own.

~5 : 1

BOARD VOLUNTEERS PER ELECTED OFFICIAL

Appointed planning, finance, parks, public-safety and ethics volunteers — the least-served users in govtech.

The cost of being under-prepared is not a bad quarter. It is being wrong on the record, in public, on video.

Source: research/spaces/GOVTECH_MUNICIPAL.md (buyer archetypes); Strata market & competitive research, 30 Aug 2026, \$3.

They already tried the obvious fix.

Every prospect has a working solution today. It is free, it is universally deployed, and it is the reason nobody in this category has bought anything.

WHAT THEY DO NOW

- Ctrl+F the PDF for a word they hope appears.
- Call the clerk — who has their own job.
- Ask the one colleague who has been on council longest.
- Vote, and find out afterwards.

WHAT IT COSTS THEM

- Hours per packet, on unpaid time.
- Precedent they never find, because they did not know the word for it.
- Cost history that lives three budgets back.
- Deferring to staff on a decision that is legally theirs.

The competitor we actually have to beat is Ctrl+F.

Source: research/spaces/GOVTECH_MUNICIPAL.md — "the real incumbent is the manual workaround."

Your city already published the answer.

*“Search returns documents and leaves the reading to you.
Strata returns an answer, and the documents behind it.”*



Strata creates no new data and asks the city to change nothing. Budgets, ordinances, minutes and contracts are already published under the Public Information Act. The record is not missing — it is unusable at meeting-prep speed.

Source: stratacivicsolutions.com (fetched 30 Aug 2026), quoted verbatim; Tex. Gov't Code ch. 552.

2026 is the year cities wrote their AI policies.

The most common AI-related item on a council agenda this year is adopting an AI-use policy. That changes which products a city can actually say yes to.

1 Incumbents shipped AI into installed bases.

CivicPlus, Granicus and OpenGov all released AI summarization in 2026 — built for the staff who prepare the meeting.

2 Councils responded with governance, not enthusiasm.

67% of municipal leaders report actively integrating AI; the agenda item is the use policy, and the objection is hallucination.

3 So the adoptable form is citation-first.

A tool that shows the page the answer came from clears an AI-use policy. A tool that summarizes without one does not.

The window is the gap between incumbents serving staff and someone serving the official.

Source: CivicPlus/Granicus AI releases 2026; EY 2025 municipal-leader survey; civicq.com, "Government AI Adoption in 2026."

Ask a question. See the page it came from.

Three surfaces, one job: walk into the meeting knowing the record. Built and live today.

Ask Strata

Plain-language Q&A over the city's own budgets, ordinances, minutes and contracts. Every answer resolves to a specific document page.

Outcome: the question you had at 10pm, answered before the meeting.

Meeting Prep

Each agenda item briefed with its own history and what it has cost the city before.

Outcome: hours of packet reading become minutes of reading that matters.

City Snapshot

One page: revenue, spending, tax rates, payroll by position.

Outcome: a new board volunteer is useful in their first month, not their first year.

Setup is on us. The city does not change how it works, and nothing migrates.

Source: stratacivicsolutions.com — /what-is-strata, /how-it-works (fetched 30 Aug 2026).



“An answer you cannot check is an answer you cannot use.”

The citation is not a feature of the product. It is the product. The official verifies the page and then speaks — so the vote, the discussion and the judgment stay exactly where the law puts them.

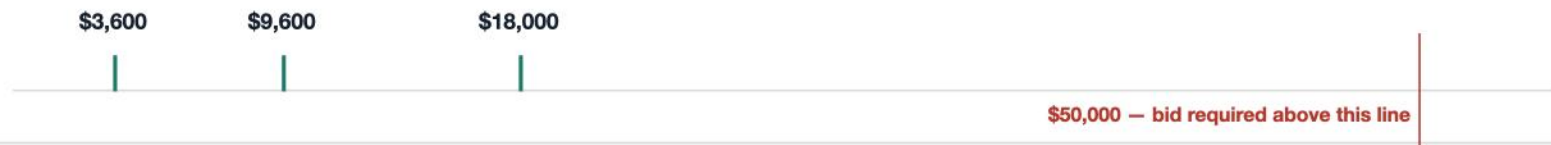
Strata assists; it does not draft the record or determine the vote. An error is an embarrassment and a churn event — not statutory liability. That boundary is a design decision.

Source: stratacivicsolutions.com, quoted verbatim; liability framing per [research/spaces/GOVTECH_MUNICIPAL.md](#).

One city manager can sign this.

Texas requires competitive bidding above \$50,000. Our top tier is \$18,000. That is a design decision, not an accident.

ANNUAL CONTRACT VALUE AGAINST THE §252.021 COMPETITIVE-BIDDING THRESHOLD



Economic buyer: the city manager. Controls the software line and can sign alone below the threshold.

Champion and user: mayors, council, boards. They feel the pain; they do not hold the budget.

Gatekeepers: the clerk, and IT in 50k+ cities. Ally or blocker — and a security questionnaire.

Demo to signature: 4–8 weeks. Not a procurement season.

Buying window is Aug–Sep. Texas fiscal years start Oct 1; budgets adopt just before.

No sales tax, no per-seat fees. Municipalities are exempt (Tex. Tax Code §151.309); pricing is by population tier.

Source: Tex. Loc. Gov't Code §§252.021, 252.0215; Tex. Tax Code §151.309; research/spaces/GOVTECH_MUNICIPAL.md.

Our senior advisor was mayor of our reference city. Twice.

Elected officials buy from people who have sat in their chair. In this category the differentiated asset is distribution, not technology.

Ralph Gutierrez

SENIOR MUNICIPAL ADVISOR

Two-term mayor and council member of Schertz — our demo city. ~50 years public service, USAF veteran, 20 years of federal judiciary leadership.

Raquel Gutierrez

MUNICIPAL OUTREACH ADVISOR

30+ years of Central Texas civic engagement. Drives municipal partnerships and pilot development — the warm-intro channel is hers.

Holly Richard

FOUNDER / CEO

Doctor of Physical Therapy; previously built healthcare and fitness businesses. An outsider to govtech — which is why the product is built for the official, not the staff.

[NEEDS JOSELEOS]

Helena Carre, Founder / CTO — no published bio.

A blank CTO on an investor deck is a live objection, not a gap.

Also missing: Holly's own account of why municipal records.

A former mayor's recommendation is how you get into 230 city halls. It is not purchasable at any seed size.

Source: [stratacivicsolutions.com /company/team](https://stratacivicsolutions.com/company/team); Strata market & competitive research, 30 Aug 2026, §2.5.

Live product. One demo city. Zero paying customers.

Said first, with dates, because the alternative is having it discovered.

	STATUS	AS OF	SOURCE
Product	Built and live — Ask Strata, Meeting Prep, City Snapshot in production	Aug 2026	Company site
Reference city	Schertz, TX (~50k) — live demo city with cached example queries; has not committed to paying	Aug 2026	Site + joseleos
Customer discovery	4 council interviews completed	Jun 2026	HermesX note — second-hand
Entity	Delaware Public Benefit Corporation, foreign-qualified in Texas	Aug 2026	joseleos
Revenue	\$0. Zero paying cities is an explicit model input, not an oversight.	—	MODEL.md
Pipeline	NOT DISCLOSED — no verified commitments, LOIs or pilots in flight	—	NEEDS JOSELEOS

No usage metric appears on this deck because no one has given us a verified one. A number we cannot defend is worth less than the blank.

Source: product/FINANCIAL_BRIEF_STRATA.md; product/finance/strata/MODEL.md; joseleos 30 Aug 2026.

Everyone else built AI for the people who prepare the meeting.

Full disclosure — the category is young but no longer empty.

VENDOR	PRIMARY BUYER	CORE JOB	SCALE SIGNAL	OVERLAP
Strata	Elected & appointed officials	Prep before a vote, cited answers	1 demo city, pre-revenue	—
Ordinal AI	Officials + staff, multi-dept	Research, live meeting Q&A, public chatbot	\$1M seed; 7+ live cities	High
CivicSummary	Public + officials	Summaries + follow-through tracking	Early pilots (West Hollywood)	Medium
Aware	Public, press, residents	Post-meeting summaries, news digest	3,800+ cities claimed; thin usage	Low–Med
CivicPlus	City staff	AI-assisted agenda & minutes drafting	Large installed base; AI as upsell	Med–High
Granicus	City staff, larger governments	Records & comms summarization	Entrenched enterprise incumbent	Medium
OpenGov	Finance & budget staff	Budgeting, ERP, performance reporting	Well-funded incumbent	Low
Ctrl+F	Everyone, today	Find the word, hope it is the right one	Free. Universally deployed.	The one to beat

Source: Strata market & competitive research, 30 Aug 2026, §5 — sources cited inline in that brief.

BUSINESS MODEL

\$3,600 to \$18,000 a year. 89% gross margin.

Population-tiered annual subscription. No per-seat fees — the category norm, and the reason a whole council and every board volunteer can use it on one contract.

STARTER

\$3,600

Smallest cities. Under 10,000.

CORE

\$9,600

The modeled ACV. Cities 10,000–50,000 — our beachhead tier.

GROWTH

\$18,000

Larger cities, more boards, more packet volume.

GROSS MARGIN

89%

COGS is ≈\$75/city/month — inference and retrieval. It scales with packet volume, not seats.

Annual invoice, ACH or check. Onboarding \$500–1,500, waived for pilots.

Usage bundled. An official who uses it twice a week costs the same as one who uses it twice a year.

ACV is capped by design. Everything stays under the \$50k bid threshold, which is what makes the 4–8 week cycle possible.

Retention is budget-line retention. Model uses 0.6%/mo logo churn ≈93%/yr; the 90–95% public-sector figure is vendor-reported, low-confidence.

Source: product/finance/strata/MODEL.md (engine v1, base case); GTM pricing table §4.

230 Texas cities in our tier. We counted them one at a time.

Bottom-up only. The national number is shown for context and is deliberately not modeled.

230 · Texas cities, 10k–50k pop.

× \$9,600 Core = ≈ \$2.2M SAM

1,224 · Texas municipalities, all sizes

The state expansion path,
unmodeled

19,519 · U.S. municipalities (+16,360 towns)

Context only. We do not claim it.

A \$2.2M beachhead is a small number and we are not going to dress it up.

It is the number we can defend, city by city, against a published population table. If a fund needs a national TAM underwritten today, this is the wrong stage of this company.

Source: [research/spaces/GOVTECH_MUNICIPAL.md](#) (TX counts); U.S. Census / National League of Cities via Strata research brief §4.1.

Thirty-one cities and break-even in month 19 — on founder effort alone.

Base case from the accepted three-year model. Founder pay is deferred and no financing appears in any scenario.

	PAYING CITIES (END)	REVENUE	OPERATING INCOME	ENDING CASH
Year 1 (FY27)	5.4	\$26,660	-\$13,104	-\$3,104
Year 2 (FY28)	14.8	\$103,894	-\$16,398	-\$19,502
Year 3 (FY29)	31.2	\$248,290	+\$51,103	+\$31,600

Month 19

first month of positive operating income

≈\$325k

ARR run-rate exiting month 36

\$1,225

CAC, paid back in 1.7 months

Five assumptions move this answer: opening cash (\$10k) · new cities/mo (0.35, +5%) · ACV (\$9,600 Core) · hire timing (contractor m13, engineer m28) · COGS (\$75/city/mo).

Source: product/finance/strata/MODEL.md — engine v1, deterministic; upside and downside in the appendix.

The risks, from the one you will ask about to the one that actually ends it.

OUTER — MARKET

“Isn't this a feature CivicPlus ships next quarter?”

It already did — for staff. Our user has no seat in those systems and no staff. An incumbent would have to build a different product for a different person and sell it into a body that did not procure it.

MIDDLE — COMPETITION

Ordinal AI is funded and ahead.

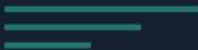
\$1M seed, 7+ live cities, and a broader surface: planners, clerks, code enforcement, 311, plus a public chatbot. Broad and shallow. We are narrow and deep on one buyer inside the same building.

INNER — EXECUTION

One founder, 0.35 cities a month, and a \$29,069 cash trough at month 18.

This is the one that actually ends it, and it is the reason the ask on the next slide is the size it is. Hire timing is the most sensitive input in the model; an earlier draft that hired an engineer at month 16 sank the base case to **-\$101k**.

Source: `product/finance/strata/MODEL.md` sensitivities; `pitch/strata/objections.md`.



We do not need a round. We need \$40,000 and five pilot cities.

USE OF FUNDS — TRACED TO THE MODEL

≈\$29k covers the cash trough — the base case bottoms at $-\$29,069$ in month 18

\$11.7k year-1 sales and marketing: the TML annual conference plus about one regional event a month

\$6k formation and Texas foreign qualification

\$10.6k G&A — the \$1M GL + cyber certificate cities require before data access, accounting, software

What it unlocks: five pilot cities converting in months 4–9, the first paying cities by month 6, and positive operating income from month 19 without a second raise.

Source: product/finance/strata/MODEL.md — capital need \$29,069 base / \$32,738 upside / \$31,557 downside; ≈\$40k from launch in every scenario.

[NEEDS JOSELEOS — THE ONE OPEN DECISION]

\$40k is the only ask the accepted model supports: bootstrapped, no financing in any scenario.

If you want an institutional round instead, say the number and the model has to be re-run financed before this slide is true.

If the deck is for pilots and partners rather than capital, the ask becomes five pilot slots and the dollar figure comes off.

All three scenarios, side by side.

The engine is deterministic; cash and personnel reconcile every period.

METRIC	BASE	UPSIDE	DOWNSIDE
3-year revenue	\$378,843	\$922,560	\$107,511
Paying cities at month 36	31.2	71.3	10.7
Ending cash, month 36	\$31,600	\$309,645	-\$4,472
Capital need to break-even	\$29,069	\$32,738	\$31,557
First month operating income ≥ 0	7	4	15
Gross margin	89.0%	91.0%	79.0%
ACV	\$9,600	\$11,000	\$7,200
CAC / payback	\$1,225 / 1.7 mo	\$592 / 0.7 mo	\$3,009 / 6.3 mo
Net revenue retention	98.0%	103.0%	88.0%
What it assumes	0.35 cities/mo +5%/mo; contractor m13, engineer m28	0.5 cities/mo +7%/mo; Core-heavy mix; hires pulled forward	0.2 cities/mo; discounting to \$7.2k; 1.2%/mo churn; never hires

Source: product/finance/strata/MODEL.md, engine v1 (30 Aug 2026). Estimates for planning; not investment advice.

How a Texas city actually buys this.

The mechanics that shaped the pricing, the calendar and the cost model.

Competitive bidding above \$50,000. Tex. Loc. Gov't Code §252.021. Below it the city manager can usually sign; many charters set lower internal thresholds, so we verify per city.

\$3k–\$50k needs two HUB quotes where practicable. §252.0215 — a form, not a season.

Cooperative purchasing is the shortcut for larger cities.
BuyBoard, TIPS, DIR — later-stage, not the beachhead motion.

TX-RAMP binds state agencies, not cities. Tex. Gov't Code §2054.0593 — but cities borrow the questionnaire.

Everything is a public record. Public Information Act, Tex. Gov't Code ch. 552 — contracts and data handling are disclosable. We hold documents the city already published, so there is little that was not public to begin with.

\$1M GL + cyber certificate before data access. A routine precondition — an early G&A line in the model, not a later one.

Buying and renewal cluster Aug–Sep. Texas city fiscal years mostly begin Oct 1 (Loc. Gov't Code ch. 102).

Channels: TML, TCMA, ELGL. TML annual conference 11–13 Nov 2026, San Antonio. Advisor-led warm intros are the highest-ROI channel at zero budget.

Source: research/spaces/GOVTECH_MUNICIPAL.md — statutes cited inline.

Six things this deck does not know.

The pitch-deck skill forbids inventing a metric. Each item below is a hole we left visible rather than filled.

	ITEM	WHY IT MATTERS	OWNER
1	Founder story	Holly's own account of why municipal records. The team slide is complete but flat without it.	joseleos
2	CTO bio	Helena Carre has no published bio. Researcher flagged it as a website trust gap; on this deck it is a live objection.	joseleos
3	Traction specifics	Schertz usage, verbal commitments, LOIs, pilots in flight. Slide 10 says "not disclosed" because nothing is verified.	joseleos
4	The ask	\$40k is the only figure the accepted model supports. An institutional round needs a financed model re-run before slide 16 is true.	joseleos
5	Pricing contradiction	The model prices Core at \$9,600; the June/July meeting notes floated ~\$50k/yr and a ~\$20k 60-day pilot. Both cannot be true — and \$50k breaks the no-bid design.	joseleos + HermesX
6	Missing GTM source	Strata_GTM_Strategy.docx and Strata_Market_Research.docx are cited by the brief but are not on disk. Positioning here was rebuilt from the space profile and the BMC.	HermesX

Source: [pitch/strata/foundation.md](#) §Gate 1; [pitch/strata/objections.md](#) Q16–Q18.